

NEWSLETTER

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Industrial Talk by PPG

Group 3

SUMMARY

In the talk, PPG representatives shared insights about the company and its use of enterprise systems to manage global operations. PPG is a leading multinational with over 140 years of history, producing paints and coatings for various industries worldwide. Operating in more than 70 countries with annual revenue of about USD 15.8 billion, PPG is known for its innovation, sustainability, and core values under The PPG Way, which emphasize teamwork, trust, and continuous improvement.



The speakers also introduced Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems, explaining that ERP integrates key business functions such as finance, HR, manufacturing, and sales into one unified platform. SAP, the world's leading ERP software, supports both functional areas (like Finance, Sales, and Materials Management) and technical aspects (such as ABAP programming and data analytics using SAP Analytics Cloud). PPG applies SAP across major process flows including Procure to Pay (PTP), Demand to Replenish (DTR), Order to Cash (OTC), and Record to Report (RTR), ensuring efficient operations across its global supply chain.

Lastly, the talk highlighted SAP-related career opportunities at PPG, especially through the Malaysia Technology Center (MYTC). Students can gain real-world experience, mentorship, and potential full-time positions after internship. The session concluded by emphasizing that SAP expertise is highly valued and offers a promising, future-oriented career path in the IT field.

TECHNOLOGIES AND ISSUES DISCUSSED IN THE VISIT

PPG started its digital backbone with SAP R/2 across Sigma operations in North America, Brazil and Belgium. Core modules included, Financial Accounting(FI), Materials Management(MM), Sales & Distribution(SD) and Production Planning(PP)

A technical leap forward: upgrading R/3 to ECC with Unicode support enabled multilingual data handling and global system compatibility

PPG plans to upgrade ECC to SAP S/4HANA Cloud, adopt RISE with SAP for transformation-as-a-service and migrate infrastructure to AWS

1991
SAP R/2 Era Begins

1999
Global Rollouts with SAP R/3 ECC

2007
Unicode Upgrade

2018
S/4HANA in ANZ

2025
Full Cloud Migration

PPG expanded its digital reach globally, adopting SAP R/3 ECC to unify operations and standardize business processes across regions.

PPG implements it in Australia and New Zealand, signaling a shift toward real-time analytics and simplified data models

REFLECTION

Teh Ru Qian A23CS0191

From the industry talk, I learned that PPG is a global company known for its paints and coatings, and they use SAP systems to manage their business operations like finance, materials, sales, and production. The timeline helped me understand how SAP supports companies in improving their processes and making better decisions. I found it interesting to see how technology evolves over time, and this talk made me consider PPG as a possible career path in the future because of their focus on innovation and global teamwork.

REFLECTION

Tan Yi Ya A23CS0187

The PPG industry talk was an eye-opening experience that gave me a better understanding of how large companies operate using enterprise systems like SAP. I learned how technology connects different parts of a business and ensures everything runs smoothly. The speakers also showed how PPG's strong values and global presence contribute to its long-term success. I found it interesting to see how SAP supports processes like production, sales, and finance in one integrated system. Overall, the talk inspired me to explore future career opportunities in IT and enterprise systems.